periods, but for others the calculation is simple. The risk of death or enslavement at sea is now no worse than the prospects of staying in Myanmar.[65] Quite simply, there are plenty of Rohingyas who share the view that 'I will take a risky boat journey again as I consider that dying in a boat journey is better than staying in miserable conditions in the camps with no access to health care and employment opportunities'.[66]

Since many Rohingyas are now effectively confined to the camps, they can no longer even travel to make arrangements with the people-smuggling gangs. However, this has been resolved by the simple expedient of the smugglers setting up 'offices' in the refugee camps. A report for Human Rights Watch, which documents the appalling levels of poverty and lack of services in the camps, noted:

> In the midst of these appalling conditions, we encountered—rather incongruously—a tent filled with high tech phone and video equipment. A young mother was sitting inside and calling a relative in Malaysia, asking him to send money so that she could care for her sick mother. He had apparently left by boat some years previously. We asked about these boats leaving Burma, and whether others in the camp were keen to go too. Some nodded. But others, seemingly in charge of the tent, were evasive and hostile, and we judged that we should not stay long. We later heard from UN officials that people smugglers are very active in the camps.[77]

Effectively, it makes no difference if the next major refugee crisis is triggered by post-election violence, deliberate expulsion organised either by the military or the Rakhine extremists, or as the final response of people driven beyond despair by the denial of every reasonable expectation of a citizen of a state. It will happen unless the persecution of the Rohingyas is stopped.[68] As even some in the NLD have noticed, the series of steps taken in the run up to the elections—including the removal of the white cards, the deeply flawed census and the discriminatory election laws—leave the Rohingyas with no place in their own country.[69] This is a defining indictment of the claims that Myanmar is making a transition to being a normal democratic country, and indicates both the government's contempt for its obligations under international law and the failure of the international community in promoting serious reform.

When the next refugee crisis occurs, the regional ASEAN states will bear its brunt.[70] The traditional movement of refugees in May and June 2015 only came to international attention because Indonesia and Malaysia closed their borders. Historically ASEAN, as with many regional collections of post-colonial states, has stressed the importance of non-